UQ Computing Society
2026 Industry Officer's Report

Jevi Waugh

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2026 at a Glance

Sponsorship Growth

During my term as Industry Officer, UQCS achieved its highest annual sponsorship income since 2021, a 43% increase from last year. We also expanded our industry network, diversified our sponsors and delivered more opportunities for students. We grew from 10 industry sponsors in 2025 to 13 in 2026, welcoming 7 new companies while re-establishing relationships with 6 previous industry partners. Industry outreach also expanded significantly. In 2025, UQCS contacted 43 companies out of a target of 67, achieving 64.2% of its outreach target. In 2026, we contacted 153 companies out of a target of 218, achieving 70.2%. This represents a 256% increase in the number of companies contacted, reflecting a considerably more ambitious approach to industry engagement.

The Art of Selling

One of my priorities this year was improving how we present UQCS to potential sponsors. I revised our sponsorship prospectus, adding more statistics to better showcase the society's achievements and demonstrate the value we offer industry partners. I also introduced facilitated outreach to a filtered group of high-achieving Computer Science students for Gold and Emerald sponsors, with enhanced priority outreach reserved for Emerald sponsors. These additions strengthened the recruitment value of our packages and supported a $250 increase across all sponsorship tiers. Ultimately, the goal was to strengthen the value of our sponsorship packages while creating greater opportunities for students.

Outreach & New Industry Relationships

This year, I restructured our approach to industry outreach by distributing cold-calling responsibilities among myself, John, Ryan, Sean, and Suvin. I assigned them companies we had not previously engaged with, while I personally focused on larger companies and strategic partnerships. A huge thank you to these four for their contributions.

My role involved much more than simply sending emails. From November 2025 to March 2026, I spent considerable time making calls, arranging meetings, following up with companies, negotiating sponsorship agreements and maintaining relationships. Some partnerships required multiple meetings, others ended in rejection, and some discussions even kept me at a bar until midnight. Securing sponsorships takes persistence, patience and a willingness to put yourself out there.

Ultimately, this approach allowed us to expand our industry network while dedicating more time and attention to building meaningful, long-term relationships.

Sponsorship

Stream 1: Industry Sponsorship

Our sponsors represent a diverse range of industries, from trading and software to quantum technology and aerospace.

Tier	Company	Sector	Amount
Emerald	Jane Street	Trading	$3,250.00 AUD
Emerald	*Tanda	HR Technology	$3,250.00 AUD
Emerald	*CyberMetrix	Cybersecurity	$3,250.00 AUD
Gold	*Citadel Securities	Trading	$2,750.00 AUD
Gold	*Quantum Australia	Quantum	$2,750.00 AUD
Bespoke Gold	*Atlassian	Software	$2,500.00 AUD
Silver	Oracle	Software	$2,250.00 AUD
Silver	IMC	Trading	$2,250.00 AUD
Bronze	VivCourt	Trading	$1,250.00 AUD
Bronze	*ApexFinCap	FinTech	$1,250.00 AUD
Bespoke	Boeing	Aerospace	$1,538.46 AUD
Bespoke	Optiver	Trading	$1,250.00 AUD
Bespoke Digital	*getcracked.io	Education	$981.42 AUD
		Total	**$28,519.88 AUD**

*getcracked.io originally paid $768.00 USD with a 1.27 conversion. * New industry partner secured in 2026.*

Stream 2: CodeJam Sponsorship

I increased the CodeJam prize pool by $100 compared to last year, from $430 to $530, offering greater rewards and value to participating students.

Sponsor	Prize / Award	Amount
IMC	Gift Card: 1st Place	$250.00 AUD
IMC	Gift Card: 2nd Place	$100.00 AUD
IMC	Gift Card: 3rd Place	$80.00 AUD
IMC	Best First Year	$100.00 AUD
	Total	**$530.00 AUD**

Stream 3: Hackathon Sponsorship

I also secured additional prize sponsors with Zain's help, bringing Hackathon's total prize pool to $3,250 which had never been attempted before.

Sponsor	Prize / Award	Amount
RiseOS	Best Overall	$2,000.00 AUD
Ventures	People's Choice	$500.00 AUD
Nuaxion	Best Game	$250.00 AUD
Spatial Synergy	Best Community	$250.00 AUD
*Flexify	Best Interdisciplinary	$251.33 AUD
	Total	**$3,251.33 AUD**

**Flexify originally paid in USD.*

Sponsorship Streams	Amount
Industry Sponsorship	$28,519.88 AUD
Hackathon Sponsorship	$3,251.33 AUD
CodeJam Sponsorship	$530.00 AUD
Total 2026 Sponsorship	**$32,301.21 AUD**
[redacted] 2025 Outstanding Sponsorship Recovered	$3,000.00 AUD
Total Revenue Collected in 2026	**$35,301.21 AUD**

When I first took on this role, my goal was never simply to bring in as much money as possible. I wanted to build relationships with companies and turn those relationships into opportunities for our students.
That being said, it's still pretty satisfying to see the numbers grow. We achieved a 43% increase in sponsorship revenue compared to last year, expanded our industry sponsor portfolio and significantly increased our social partnerships. More importantly, we built a stronger foundation for the next committee to continue developing.
Ultimately, I would rather be remembered for the opportunities we created than the amount of money we raised.

How it Compares

Year	**2026**	2025	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020
Total ($)	**32,301.21**	22,581.66	15,500.00	22,467.25	30,721.74	33,217.32	12,276.15

[redacted] *2025 sponsorship has been intentionally excluded to accurately reflect income received during the year. UQ Union grants and the estimated monetary value of Red Bull Wings provided as in-kind sponsorship have also been excluded from the total sponsorship income.*

Social Partnerships

Social sponsorship grew by 200% compared to 2025, tripling our portfolio from two to six partners and expanding the range of benefits available to UQCS members.

As Industry Officer, I wanted social partnerships to offer practical value. Elohim Studio supports event photography, CR8 assists with branding, and Ciao Bello provides food support. Jetts Fitness and Urban Climb promote healthier, more active lifestyles, while Red Bull supports Hackathon through Wings. My goal was to diversify our partnerships and ensure each contributed something meaningful to UQCS.

Social Sponsorship Comparison

Sponsor	2025	2026
Red Bull	✓	✓
Ciao Bello	✓	✓
CR8		✓
Jetts Fitness		✓
Elohim Studio		✓
Urban Climb		✓
Total	**2**	**6**

We also secured 430 cans of Red Bull through the Wings program to support our Hackathon participants which was significantly more than last year.

Key Industry & Academic Events

High Frequency Networking

Co-hosted with UQLIT and EBESS, HFN brought together 13 companies, with UQCS contributing connections to 9, including shared industry relationships.

Industry Representation	Companies
UQCS	Citadel Securities, Boeing, Tanda, Oracle, Microsoft
Shared Relationships	Jane Street, Optiver, Atlassian, VivCourt
Partner Societies	Fenwick, NTI, Deswik, DFR

- **Quantum Careers Night**

  Quantum Careers Night was a successful collaboration between societies, with particularly strong participation from UQCS students.

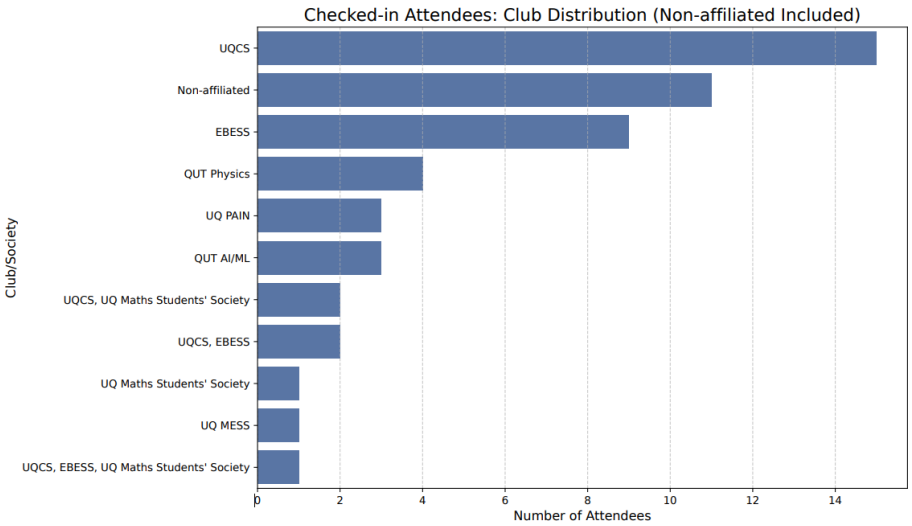


Figure 1: Checked-in students at QCN.

- **Industry Panel** The Industry Panel attracted around 60 attendees, connecting students with industry representatives.
- **Citadel Securities Cryptography Challenge** Despite being held a day after HFN, the event attracted 51 registrations and approximately 30 attendees.
- **What is CS?** Using academic connections, I brought together researchers, lecturers, industry representatives and students, securing nearly 80 registrations.

Passing the Torch

To my knowledge, I'm the first Industry Officer to revise prospectuses at both ends of my term.

As UQCS grows, so do our responsibilities and the need for support. I'm proud of the standards we've set and hope my successor takes them even further.

Goals for 2027

- **Digital Infrastructure:** Align the website with our prospectus and introduce digital membership cards for social sponsor benefits, supported by a dedicated Infrastructure Officer.
- **Partnerships:** Money isn't the goal. What matters is having companies that genuinely show up for our students and give them opportunities.

Personal Statement

My journey with UQCS began rather unexpectedly. It was Zain and Masham, whom I met in our capstone course (DECO3801), who encouraged me to apply. Given my experience in leadership and my enjoyment of meeting people, Industry Officer seemed like a natural fit. Balancing this role alongside full-time university studies and three jobs was certainly challenging. I've always believed in leading by example, setting high standards for myself and surrounding myself with people who challenge me to become better. I hope my leadership reflected that philosophy and encouraged those around me to aim just as high. Looking back, I'm proud of what we achieved, although none of it would have been possible without the people around me.

I'd particularly like to thank Masham, not only for encouraging me to take on this role in the first place, but also for her support and encouragement throughout the year. A special thank you to Zain for encouraging me to join and sharing my rather unique sense of humour; Clare for being genuinely lovely to work with and helping deliver our industry events; Tyreece, who, like me, is also Mauritian, for helping us fulfil our marketing commitments to sponsors and John for providing a diplomatic perspective that often balanced my more direct approach. A particular thank you to Ryan and Sean for supporting our industry outreach, and to April and the rest of the committee for their contributions throughout the year.

I would have loved to continue as Industry Officer, but my next chapter hopefully takes me to the Technical University of Munich (TUM) in Germany. To my successor, I hope you continue building on what we've achieved and set even higher standards.

For someone who never planned to join the committee, it's been quite a year.

> "**It's not who I am underneath, but what I do, that defines me.**"
>
> *Bruce Wayne - Batman Begins* (2005)

Until the next chapter,



Jevi Schallum Waugh
UQCS Industry Officer